

Early-morning deep synthesis. Assembles the already-baked projection bundle with the league scouting boards — nothing is recomputed. Companion to the gameday one-pager; this is the scouting-and-reasoning layer.

Fair-value readout (audit, not a directional call)

- **Fair spread:** MIN by 6.2 (model home-margin -6.2).
- **Fair projected score:** MIN 79.6 — WAS 75.4.
- **Fair total:** 155.0.
- **Rest:** WAS 2d / MIN 2d — even rest.
- *These are the platform's own fair lines — an audit of the model, not a directional call. No market price is quoted or implied.*

MIN — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** Kayla McBride grades best among qualified defenders on the floor (SAE +6.27/100 on 61 rim shots faced). Also above-average at the rim: Maya Caldwell (+5.35), Courtney Williams (+5.17).
- **Zone scoring — Kayla McBride:** league-board shot-maker (Corner 3, +19.2 PAX/100).
- **Zone scoring — Courtney Williams:** league-board shot-maker (Short mid-range, +12.1 PAX/100).

MIN — rotation reasoning

- **Out (1):** Napheesa Collier — their minutes are redistributed across the rotation below.
- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Olivia Miles (36), Kayla McBride (35), Courtney Williams (32), Natasha Howard (28), Nia Coffey (15).

WAS — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** no qualified rim protector projects onto the floor — MIN's at-rim scorers face a soft interior.
- **Zone scoring — Shakira Austin:** league-board shot-maker (At the rim, +12.8 PAX/100).
- **Elite finisher:** Sonia Citron (+12.0 PAX/100 overall).

WAS — rotation reasoning

- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Sonia Citron (33), Shakira Austin (30), Kiki Iriafen (28), Michaela Onyenwere (26), Georgia Amoore (24).
- **Provisional basis (read with caution):** Georgia Amoore [rookie_prior] — projected off a thin / prior-shrunk sample, not a settled rolling rate.

Matchup implication

- **MIN at the rim:** WAS projects no qualified rim protector on the floor — MIN's interior scorers face a soft rim (last-season grades).
- **WAS at the rim:** must contend with Kayla McBride (rim SAE +6.27/100, last season) anchoring MIN's interior.

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